Magic rule – Rituals · SRD 5.2.1

A spell with the **Ritual** tag can be cast as a **ritual**: it takes **10 minutes longer** but costs **no spell slot**. You must have it **prepared** (except the wizard, who uses the spellbook).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. The spell needs the **Ritual** tag.
2. Casting time: **+10 minutes**.
3. **No slot** spent.
4. The spell must be **prepared** (spellbook for the wizard).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 clarifies a ritual must be prepared and can't be cast at a higher level.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say what happens if the ritual is interrupted. Fix: the spell fails and no slot is lost; start again.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the ritual: candles, chalk, whispers, minutes of focus.

Step 1 – Check:

Does the spell have the **Ritual** tag and is it prepared (or in the wizard's spellbook)?

Step 2 – Plan the time:

Normal time +10 minutes. An action becomes 10 minutes.

Step 3 – Components:

Material components are still needed.

Step 4 – Cast:

No slot is spent; the spell is at its base level.

Step 5 – Effect:

The spell works normally; Concentration applies if it requires it.

Example: Mira casts Detect Magic as a ritual (10 minutes + action) without spending a slot and searches the crypt.

⚠ Common questions:

How much longer?

10 minutes.

Is a slot needed?

No.

Must the spell be prepared?

Yes, except the wizard (spellbook).

Can I cast it higher?

No, no higher level.

Material components?

Still required.

If interrupted?

The spell fails, nothing is lost.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Ritual in combat

Can I do it in combat? **Option**: no, too long.

Several rituals

Can I chain them? **Option**: one at a time.

Ritual and Concentration

Can I cast one while concentrating? **Option**: yes if it needs no Concentration.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Ritual tag

Only spells tagged Ritual allow it.

Wizard

Uses the spellbook without preparing the spell.

No slot

A ritual costs no spell slot.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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